

Philipp Hilbert. *Trading product leader who knows the stack beneath the orderbook.*

Positioning, ten years shipping regulated fintech and data platforms, now ready to own the trading ecosystem at FundedNext end-to-end. ≤ 25 words.

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§ WHY NEXT VENTURES

FundedNext's core proposition, performance-based capital for 220,000 daily active traders across 170 nations, is a product problem at every layer: execution quality, risk guardrails, onboarding, compliance, and the platform plumbing that ties it together. The explicit mention of MT5 and cTrader integration in the job description tells me the engineering surface is real, not cosmetic, and that cross-functional alignment with Compliance and Risk is already baked into the model, exactly the environment where my regulated-fintech background compounds. What draws me most is the scale: a global user base with live capital on the line means every prioritisation call has measurable, immediate consequences. *That is exactly the pressure I do my best work under.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

My background is fintech infrastructure, payments, and regulated data platforms rather than prop-trading operations specifically; I have not sat inside a prop firm before. The transferable mechanic is strong, however: I have repeatedly owned products where a wrong decision costs real money in regulated, latency-sensitive environments, payment systems, national health data, defence AI, and I bring deep hands-on knowledge of crypto market microstructure, perpetuals, DEX mechanics, and execution quality from years of active trading on Hyperliquid, Bitget, and Jupiter.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
 - **GitHub Copilot**, pair-programming across the full stack
 - **Lovable**, rapid clickable prototypes in hours
 - **GPT**, research, edge-case generation, user-story drafts
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow and automation design
 - **Framer**, design-heavy flows and landing pages
 - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks and product briefs
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted code review and navigation
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB; Kafka for event streaming; Dagster and dbt for ETL orchestration; Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, and GitOps for rollout pipelines; Shopware for e-commerce integration; WhatsApp and Telegram messaging APIs; CGM/KIS clinical interfaces; payment and forecourt POS systems; LLM agent frameworks under custom guardrails.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT NEXT VENTURES

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the trading operations and support teams, map every handoff between MT5/cTrader, internal tooling, and compliance workflows, and surface the top three friction points by ticket volume before touching the backlog.

WEEK 2

Slice and validate.

Turn the highest-friction finding into a scoped story with clear acceptance criteria, walk it through engineering and compliance together, and get a prototype in front of one operations lead for a first reaction.

WEEK 3 +

Ship, measure, repeat.

Own the first release end-to-end, rollout plan, internal training, success metric baseline, then lock the discovery cadence so the backlog is always pulled by evidence rather than pushed by opinion.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at NEXT Ventures,

FundedNext's model of performance-based capital, putting real money behind 220,000 traders who have proven they can manage risk, is a fintech product problem at a scale most PMs never encounter. Every platform decision, from how quickly a payout clears to how clearly a drawdown limit is surfaced, has direct financial consequences for real people. That accountability is what drew me to this posting.

My ten years in product span the regulated, the technical, and the operationally complex: payment systems at Scheidt & Bachmann where a missed edge case meant a misfuelled truck; national health-data pipelines at the Bundesdruckerei and Bundesagentur für Arbeit where compliance was not a checkbox but a hard gate; and a defence AI platform at Rohde & Schwarz where rollout time went from days to thirty minutes precisely because the engineering and delivery model was rebuilt from the product layer. None of those were easy environments, and none tolerated vague requirements or untested assumptions, skills that transfer directly to a brokerage ecosystem where regulatory alignment and high-stakes execution happen simultaneously.

Beyond the professional record, I trade actively across centralized and decentralized venues, Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, 1inch, Across Protocol. I work with liquidation heatmaps on Coinglass and Hyblock Capital, study execution quality and slippage dynamics, and have built backtesting tooling and algorithmic decision frameworks for my own crypto strategies. I understand what a trader needs from a platform not because I have read a report about it, but because I live on one daily.

On the AI fluency the role requires: I run production workflows with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and n8n-based agent loops, and I have built a file-queue-driven agent framework of my own. I can sit in a technical conversation with an engineer about API architecture or agent orchestration and push back when a proposed approach is over-engineered for the actual use case, which is precisely the feasibility judgment your job description calls out.

My working style is low-ego and outcome-oriented. I negotiate metrics before anyone writes a line of code, run discovery continuously rather than as a phase, and hand engineers a problem

with enough context to own it. At NEXT Ventures I would bring that same discipline to the trading product backlog from day one, starting by mapping the MT5/cTrader integration surface, identifying where user friction and compliance risk intersect, and shipping the first improvement in weeks, not quarters.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with ten years in regulated, technically complex environments, payments, health data, defence AI, and B2B SaaS, now deepening a long-standing, hands-on engagement with crypto markets into a full trading-product focus. I translate messy operational realities into clean backlogs, align engineering and compliance without losing either, and run discovery continuously so the team bets on evidence rather than opinion. My AI-native working mode means prototypes and spike analyses happen in hours, not sprints.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Trading and fintech. Payment and forecourt POS systems, PSP integration, crypto market microstructure, perpetuals, DEX mechanics, execution quality, regulatory alignment with compliance and risk teams.

Product craft. Continuous discovery, prototype-led validation, outcome negotiation, backlog and release ownership, SAFe (PI planning, release trains), RICE/Kano prioritisation, metric definition before build.

Data and AI platforms. ETL orchestration and migration, analytics platforms, LLM agent frameworks, multi-agent workflow design. Kafka, Python, Kotlin, Dagster, dbt.

Cloud, delivery and operations. Bare-metal to container migration, GitOps rollout and hotfix pipelines. Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Jenkins, Git, Azure DevOps.

AI-first building. Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Lovable, n8n, Framer, Gamma.app, Cursor.

Regulated environments. Defence, public sector, health data, insurance: identity management, audit cycles, highest privacy requirements.

Working tools: Jira, Confluence.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION MARKETPLACE, B2B SAAS 2025 TO NOW

Zero-to-one AI-assisted operations platform; WhatsApp/Telegram API integration; LLM agent orchestration for field workflows.

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM (FCAS), B2B SAAS 2024 TO 2025

Unified multimodal AI training data into one homogeneous standard; cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes; steered product from UI-heavy to dev-code-friendly. Kafka, Kotlin, Python.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC ANALYTICS PLATFORM 2023 TO 2024

Made national labour-market data searchable, filterable, and social-media-ready; delivered bare-metal-to-container migration and big ETL rebuild. Dagster, dbt.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURTECH LOW-CODE SAAS 2022

Launched Claims Center; restructured a 17-person team into three nimble squads with leads.

CLINET · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH-TECH MOBILE APP 2021 TO 2022

Native iOS/Android app with CGM/KIS clinical interface; integrated the interface personally.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER · NATIONAL HEALTH DATA PLATFORM (RKI) 2021

RKI projects DIM and DESH: vaccination statistics, viral-mutation tracking; identity management and highest-privacy compliance.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · FUEL-RETAIL INTEGRATION 2020 TO 2021

POS, payment, and forecourt systems across a SAFe programme with PI planning and release trains.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · PROCUREMENT PLATFORM 2019 TO 2020

Full legacy-to-Shopware migration for ~20,000 users.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · IT MODERNISATION, WIND ENERGY 2019

Full-site modernisation: end devices, servers, switches, lines, software.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

Kvitt (mobile payments, acquired by Sparkasse) · Qcrypt (encryption, deputy IT security officer)
· Smart Soil Technologies (nanotech)

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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